

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 6001

By White

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Ernest Burgess,
Rutherford County Chamber of Commerce 2024
Business Legend of the Year.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those individuals whose vision, ambition, and work ethic are driving forces behind the success of local economies and the economy of this State; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Ernest Burgess of Rutherford County, a duly lauded business leader and former mayor who has improved the economy of this State and the well-being of its citizens in innumerable ways; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Burgess was recently named the 2024 Business Legend of the Year by the Rutherford County Chamber of Commerce, an honor most befitting his indelible legacy; and

WHEREAS, a lifelong Rutherford Countian, Ernest Burgess earned degrees from Middle Tennessee State University (MTSU) and the University of Tennessee, thereafter building a distinguished career as Senior Vice President of Operations at National HealthCare Corporation in Murfreesboro, in which role he played an integral part in the company's growth, particularly in expanding healthcare services; and

WHEREAS, in 2006, he transitioned into public service when he was elected as the Mayor of Rutherford County, holding that post until 2018; during his tenure, he oversaw transformative changes in the county, including enhancements to the local school system, construction of a state-of-the-art county judicial building, creation of a full-time county fire and rescue department, and fostering an environment of economic growth, marked by low unemployment rates; and

WHEREAS, a committed civic leader, Ernest Burgess has served on numerous local boards, including those of the Discovery Center, Linebaugh Library, United Way, MTSU Foundation, Doors of Hope, and Main Street Murfreesboro; and

WHEREAS, his vast record of community service has been honored with the Mindful Care Adult Day Services Community Service Award, Robert E. Rose Community Service Award from Journeys in Community Living, and Green House Ministries 12th Man Award; he was also named the 2010 Statesman of the Year by the Tennessee Republican Party; and

WHEREAS, he has been an active member of North Boulevard Church of Christ, where he previously served as an elder; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many worthy endeavors, Mr. Burgess has enjoyed the love and support of his wife, Peggy, and their three children, five grandchildren, and three great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Ernest Burgess has devoted his life to serving the citizens of Rutherford County, and it is most fitting that he be recognized at this time; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Ernest Burgess, Rutherford County Chamber of Commerce 2024 Business Legend of the Year, extending our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.